Q+A

MAMMA MIA!

It has been an eventful year for **Alia Bhatt**—motherhood, an international debut, and a KJo film that is the talk of the town...

Q. How are you feeling after *Rocky Aur Rani Kii Prem Kahaani?*

Like a kid who scored good marks in an exam (laughs)! Dharma is a second home for me, so the vibe on the set was very relaxed. Then the ensemble cast put together by Karan—Shabana Azmi, Dharmendra, Jaya Bachchan, all stalwarts!.... *RARKPK* busts the myths around perfection. The values are progressive, not just modern, and I love that it is catalysing conversations.

Q. Tell us about your role as an entrepreneur.

Both Ed-a-Mamma [a maternity- and kidswear brand] and Eternal Sunshine [production house] stemmed from searching for my identity. The transformation from a girl to a mother, besides being emotionally profound, is practically challenging. I wanted to have comfortable clothes that were acceptable aesthetically. That led to the label. With Eternal Sunshine, the idea was to expand from being an actor to a creator.

Q. How do you juggle this with your role as a mother?

I get asked this a lot, and again, that is also a learning experience where every day is a new day, with fresher challenges and new accomplishments. Honestly, Raha has changed my life and made my heart expand in a way that I can fit into several things.

Q. Then there is *Heart of Stone* next...

Heart of Stone was an exhilarating experience. It was a dream team. I was pregnant then and bonded with Gal Gadot. She told me she was also expecting when she shot *Wonder Woman*. I got to do action—something I always wanted to do! And doing it on an international level was just something else. It is one genre I'd like to do more of!

with Aarti Kapur Singh

Photograph by **BANDEEP SINGH**